MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MARKING SCHEME- 26900549 – TOURISM TREND ANALYSIS

MGU-UGP (Honours) | Fifth Semester | MG5SECTTM300 | October 2026

PART A – SHORT ANSWER (Answer any 5; 2 marks each)

1. What is tourism trend analysis?. (2 marks) Systematic study of changes/patterns in tourism over time - Uses tourist data and behaviour/preferences to identify trends and support planning/forecasting (1+1)

2. What is meant by tourism trends analysis?. (2 marks) Collecting and examining tourism-related information to identify patterns, changes and emerging developments - May compare periods, destinations, tourist groups or preferences to interpret likely future direction (1+1)

3. What is social media analysis in tourism?. (2 marks) Examining posts, comments, hashtags, shares, photos and reviews related to tourism - Identifies tourist interests, destination popularity, satisfaction and sentiment (1+1)

4. Best representation tool for changes in tourist arrivals over time. (2 marks) Line graph / line chart (2 marks)

5. Any two limitations of tourist statistics. (2 marks) Incomplete or inaccurate reporting / under-reporting - Different collection methods or definitions / delays in publication / informal tourism not recorded (1 mark each; any two)

6. Any two demographic factors influencing tourism trends. (2 marks) Age - Income / occupation / education / family size / gender / life stage (1 mark each; any two)

7. Any two characteristics of wellness tourism. (2 marks) Focus on physical, mental and emotional well-being - Includes preventive health, relaxation, yoga, meditation, spa, healthy food or retreat experiences (1 mark each)

8. How can trend analysis tools help predict tourist arrivals?. (2 marks) Use past arrival data, graphs, growth rates and seasonal patterns to identify trends - Forecast future demand to support staffing, infrastructure, marketing and resource planning (1+1)

PART B – SHORT ESSAY (Answer any 5; 5 marks each)

9. Emerging trend of spiritual and pilgrimage tourism in India. (5 marks) Meaning: travel for religious, spiritual or faith-based purposes (1) - Examples: Varanasi, Ayodhya, Tirupati, Char Dham, Bodh Gaya, major church/mosque/pilgrimage centres (1) - Growth factors: faith, heritage interest, improved access, promotion and digital booking/information (1) - Tourism benefits: local jobs, transport, accommodation, guiding, crafts and small businesses (1) - Issues/management: crowding, waste, carrying capacity, safety and protection of sacred sites; sustainable management (1)

10. Major emerging tourism trends and relevance to contemporary tourism. (5 marks) Identify relevant trends: sustainable/responsible, wellness, experiential/local, adventure/ecotourism, medical, rural, solo/Gen Z, MICE or spiritual tourism (2) - Digital trends: social media, online travel agencies, mobile booking and AI personalisation (1) - Reflect changing preferences for authentic, flexible, convenient and meaningful experiences (1) - Relevance: product innovation, destination marketing, competitiveness, employment and sustainability (1)

11. Use of empirical analysis to understand tourist behaviour and tourism trends. (5 marks) Empirical analysis uses observed/measured evidence rather than assumptions (1) - Collect primary data: surveys, interviews, observation, focus groups; secondary data: arrival

statistics, booking records, reviews and reports (1) - Analyse expenditure, length of stay, purpose, satisfaction, origin and preferences using averages, percentages, comparisons or graphs (1) - Compare groups, destinations or years to reveal patterns and changes (1) - Use findings for planning, segmentation, product development, marketing and forecasting (1)

12. Measures of central tendency for tourist expenditure or length of stay. (5 marks) Mean: total expenditure/total nights divided by number of tourists/visits; shows average (2) - Median: middle value after arranging observations; useful when extreme spending or long stays distort the mean (1.5) - Mode: most frequently occurring expenditure value or length of stay (1) - Application: compare visitor groups/destinations and support pricing, package design and planning (0.5)

13. Major challenges in analysing tourist behaviour and travel patterns. (5 marks) Incomplete, unreliable or inconsistent data and under-reporting (1) - Different definitions, collection methods and reporting periods (1) - Tourist preferences change rapidly due to trends, income, technology, crises and social media (1) - Seasonality, diverse visitor groups and difficulty representing all tourists (1) - Privacy/ethical concerns, limited resources and difficulty interpreting online data; triangulate sources and update data (1)

14. Importance of sustainability in wellness and retreat tourism. (5 marks) Protects natural landscapes, water, biodiversity and the peaceful setting on which retreats depend (1) - Reduces waste, pollution, energy use and pressure on local resources (1) - Supports local employment, community participation, local food and cultural respect (1) - Maintains authentic, safe and high-quality wellness experiences over the long term (1) - Promotes responsible visitor numbers, eco-friendly facilities and monitoring/certification where appropriate (1)

15. Role of observation in analysing local tourism experiences. (5 marks) Directly watches tourist activities, interactions and use of local places/services (1) - Records behaviour, visitor flows, waiting times, service quality, accessibility and environmental impacts (1) - Can be structured using checklists/field notes and repeated at different times/seasons (1) - Reveals details tourists may not mention in surveys; helps assess authenticity and experience quality (1) - Limitations: observer bias, limited time and privacy; combine with interviews, surveys and reviews (1)

16. Importance of sentiment analysis in understanding tourist opinions and preferences. (5 marks) Analyses text in reviews, comments and social posts to classify opinions as positive, negative or neutral (1) - Identifies satisfaction, complaints, expectations and preferred features (1) - Detects recurring themes such as service, price, cleanliness, safety, transport or attractions (1) - Helps destinations/businesses improve services, marketing and reputation management (1) - Limitations: sarcasm, language, fake reviews, bias and privacy; interpret with context and other data (1)

PART C – LONG ESSAY (Answer any 1; 15 marks each)

17. Impact of digitalisation, social media, OTAs and AI on the progress of Indian tourism. (15 marks) Introduction: digital tools have changed how tourists search, compare, book, experience and review travel (1) - Digitalisation: websites, mobile apps, digital payments, e-tickets and online information improve access, convenience and efficiency (2) - Social media: images, videos, influencers, hashtags and user-generated content create destination awareness and influence choices; reviews spread quickly (2) - Online travel agencies (OTAs): compare prices/options, enable booking of flights, hotels and packages, widen market reach and support small providers; commissions and platform dependence are challenges (2) - Artificial

intelligence: chatbots, personalised recommendations, demand forecasting, sentiment analysis, dynamic pricing and customer support (2) - Impact on Indian tourism: wider domestic/international reach, easier trip planning, new business opportunities, better data-led decisions and support for lesser-known destinations (2) - Challenges: digital divide, inaccurate/fake information, privacy and cybersecurity, algorithmic bias, platform costs and reduced human interaction (2) - Conclusion: combine technology with reliable information, digital skills, inclusive access and responsible/sustainable destination management (2)

18. Measures of central tendency and their applications in tourism data analysis. (15 marks) Introduction/meaning: central tendency summarises a dataset using a representative central value (1) - Mean: sum of all observations divided by number of observations; explain formula or calculation (3) - Median: middle value after arranging data; for an even number, average the two middle values; useful for skewed data/outliers (3) - Mode: most frequently occurring value; useful for common package price, stay duration or visitor preference categories where applicable (2) - Tourism applications: average tourist expenditure, length of stay, daily spending, room rate, visitor numbers or satisfaction scores (2) - Interpretation/use: compare destinations, seasons and visitor segments; support pricing, budgeting, marketing and planning (2) - Limitations: mean is affected by extreme values; median ignores many individual values; mode may be absent/multiple; measures alone do not show variation or explain causes (2)

19. Using tourist feedback, online reviews and social media data to identify emerging local tourism experience trends. (15 marks) Introduction: online and direct feedback provide evidence of visitor needs, perceptions and changing interests (1) - Sources: questionnaires, interviews, review platforms, ratings, comments, hashtags, posts, photos, videos and search/booking data (2) - Collection and preparation: define destination/time period, gather relevant data, remove duplicates/spam where possible, protect privacy and organise themes (2) - Methods: review coding, frequency counts, ratings, sentiment analysis, keyword/hashtag analysis, observation and comparison over time (3) - Identify trends: local food, culture and crafts, community-led activities, nature/adventure, wellness, authentic experiences or less-crowded places, where supported by the data (2) - Interpretation: compare seasons, visitor segments and positive/negative feedback; triangulate online data with surveys, observation and stakeholder views (2) - Applications: improve products and service quality, support local businesses, target marketing, manage visitor flows and guide sustainable planning (2) - Limitations/conclusion: online users may not represent all tourists; fake reviews, language, bias and changing platforms affect reliability; use ethical, balanced and regularly updated analysis (1)